



Motorcycle riders passing by a police station on Wednesday that was reportedly targeted by U.S. and Israeli airstrikes in Tehran.



Shepherds inspecting an unexploded Iranian projectile that landed in a field on the outskirts of Qamishli, eastern Syria.



Emergency crews working to put out a fire at a solar farm and power-generation facility in Tyre, on Lebanon's southern coast.

Trump Is Distancing Himself From the Conflict's Aftermath

By ANTON TROIANOVSKI

WASHINGTON — American leaders say they are “punishing” Iran, “annihilating” its navy and meting out “retribution” against its rulers.

NEWS ANALYSIS What comes after all that destruction, they increasingly insist, is not the United States' problem.

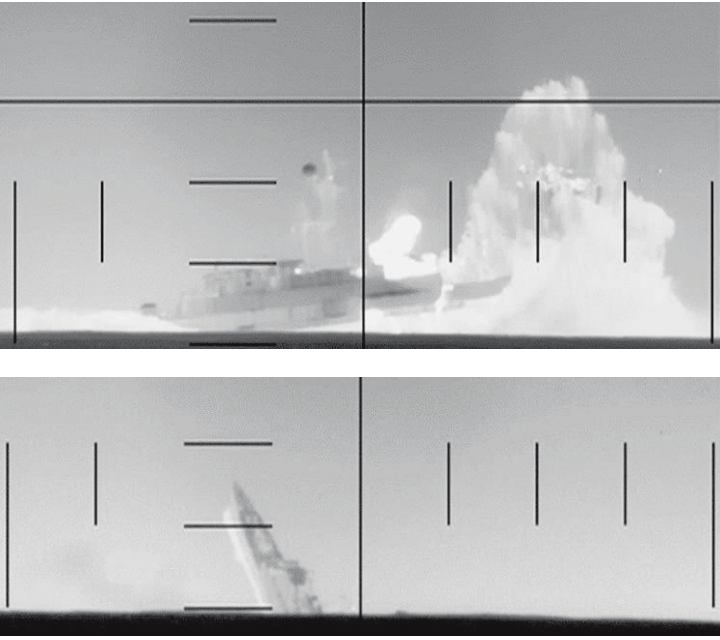
“We'll see what happens with the people,” President Trump said on Tuesday as he hosted Chancellor Friedrich Merz of Germany, referring to the possibility of a popular uprising in Iran in the wake of the war. “You know, they have their chance.”

It was the latest instance of Mr. Trump and his top officials taking pains to paint Iran's politi-

cal future as being outside the scope of American responsibility. They appeared to be trying to draw a distinction from what they derisively refer to as the “nation-building” wars in Iraq and Afghanistan. But as Mr. Trump and his backers try to show that this Middle East war is different, they are also telegraphing that the risk of chaos or even greater repression in Iran in the aftermath is not their paramount concern.

Vice President JD Vance said on Fox News's “Jesse Watters Primetime” on Monday evening that the Trump administration would prefer “a stable country.”

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Screen shots of what the Defense Department said was periscope footage from the Navy submarine that sank the Iranian warship IRIS Dena in international waters off Sri Lanka.

IRAN WAR SPREADS OUTSIDE MIDEAST AND PULLS IN NATO

Bloc Intercepts Missile Near Turkey — U.S. Sub Sinks Ship Off Sri Lanka

This article is by **Eric Schmitt, Hylene Cooper, Lara Jakes and Michael Levenson.**

The five-day-old war with Iran spread far beyond the Middle East on Wednesday as an American submarine torpedoed an Iranian Navy ship off Sri Lanka and NATO air defenses shot down an Iranian ballistic missile that was heading toward Turkish airspace.

The Iranian warship, the IRIS Dena, with a crew of 180, sank in international waters in the Indian Ocean, more than 2,000 miles from Iran. The Sri Lankan Navy rescued 32 critically injured sailors and was searching for more survivors but had encountered only bodies floating in the water near an oil slick and empty lifeboats, a spokesman said.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said it was the first time a U.S. submarine had fired a torpedo at a ship since World War II. But it was NATO's introduction into the conflict that made clear the widening scope of the fight.

“Iran is broadening the war to countries that did not attack it,” Radoslaw Sikorski, the Polish foreign affairs minister, said at a news conference with European Union leaders in Warsaw. He said, “There is a well-known saying: It's worse than a crime; it's a mistake.”

In Washington, Senate Republicans on Wednesday blocked an attempt to limit President Trump's power to continue the war against Iran without congressional authorization. The 53-to-47 vote against taking up the measure fell largely along party lines. Democrats had insisted that Congress weigh in on the open-ended military campaign [Page A5].

The Iranian missile that was heading toward Turkish airspace flew over Iraq and Syria before NATO shot it down over the eastern Mediterranean, according to a Turkish Defense Ministry statement. It did not say what the missile's target was believed to have been, but since first coming under attack on Saturday, Iran has launched hundreds of missiles and drones at countries that host U.S. military facilities.

Turkey's Incirlik Air Base hosts a sizable U.S. Air Force contingent, but Turkey has said that it would not allow its airspace to be used for attacks on Iran. A senior U.S. military official and a Western official said the Iranian strike had targeted that air base. Both officials said the missile had been shot down by an interceptor fired from a U.S. warship in the eastern

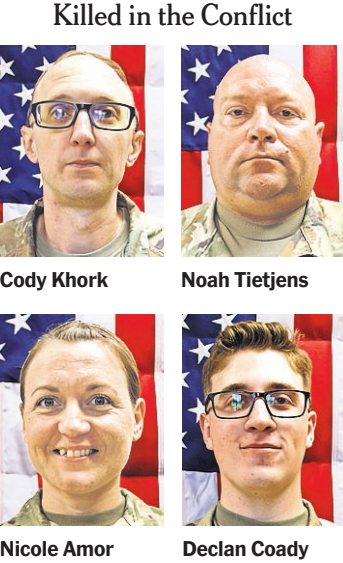
Mediterranean.

An attack on Turkey, a NATO member that shares a 300-mile border with Iran, could activate NATO's mutual defense clause, potentially drawing the alliance's 32 member states into the war.

NATO condemned the Iranian incursion.

“NATO stands firmly with all allies, including Turkey, as Iran continues its indiscriminate attacks across the region,” Allison Hart, a spokeswoman for the military alliance, said in a statement. “Our deterrence and defense posture remains strong across all domains, including when it comes to air and missile defense.”

Turkey's foreign minister,



Profiles of four U.S. troops, all assigned to the 103rd Sustainment Command in Iowa, who died during an attack in Kuwait. Page A8.

Hakan Fidan, spoke by phone with his Iranian counterpart about the missile and said that any action that could cause the conflict to spread should be avoided, Turkey's foreign ministry said.

The Turkish defense ministry said it would consult with its NATO allies and protect the country from any attacks. “All necessary steps to defend our territory and airspace will be taken resolutely and without hesitation,” it said.

As Mr. Hegseth warned that the war was still in its early stages, Israeli forces bombed command centers of the Basij, the powerful Iranian state paramilitary group.

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DANGEROUS ROUTE Dozens of oil and gas tankers are avoiding the Strait of Hormuz off Iran's coast, reducing the world's supply. **PAGE A9**

TEHRAN'S OFFER A day after the initial attacks, Iran secretly reached out to the C.I.A. to discuss terms for ending the conflict. **PAGE A10**

Haitians Find Haven in Ohio, in Echo of Underground Railroad

By MIRIAM JORDAN

SPRINGFIELD, Ohio — The upstairs room was ready.

Three teddy bears and a smiling cloth doll were propped on a neatly made bed. A bassinet was nearby. On the dresser was a sanctuary of care: baby shampoo, lotion and talcum powder.

Night was falling in Springfield, Ohio, when the Haitian mother and her month-old baby arrived. Lee, in her 70s, had never met the woman on her doorstep. Still, they embraced. After cooing over the infant, Lee led her guests on a tour of the house, ending with the bedroom that would serve as their redoubt from a feared immigration sweep.

Across Springfield that evening, anxiety was mounting. Haitians and their American supporters were awaiting a federal court ruling, expected by midnight Feb. 2, about the fate of Temporary Protected Status for Haiti, a program that has allowed beneficiaries to live and work legally in the United States.

The Trump administration had

moved to terminate the status effective Feb. 3. Without court intervention, thousands of Haitians in Springfield would become deportable overnight, and federal agents could descend on the city the very next day.

And even after the court blocked the termination, that prospect remains.

The government has asked an appeals court to overrule the lower-court decision, and in a lawsuit about Syrians, the government asked the Supreme Court last week to take emergency action that could give the administration far more power to limit or end Temporary Protected Status across the board.

More than 10,000 Haitians now call Springfield, a city of 58,000 between Dayton and Columbus, home. While some are U.S. citizens, most have Temporary Protected Status, and in the months ahead of the court ruling, many Americans had mobilized to help the growing Haitian community.

In churches and community centers, they organized prayer services, marches and petition drives. Volunteers ran practice

drills. Others agreed to serve as legal guardians for children whose Haitian parents feared they could be detained.

Some did something more risky: They discreetly converted spare bedrooms and finished basements into places of refuge.

In the days before the anticipated Feb. 3 expiration of Temporary

Protected Status, many Haitian families began withdrawing from daily life.

“Teachers, employers, pastors, schools — we all witnessed the disappearance of members of our community,” said Anna Poteet, 39, who teaches English to immi-

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Residents of Springfield, Ohio, opened their spare bedrooms as Haitian immigrants faced a deadline over their protected status.

Kennedy's Crusade on Nutrition Could Reshape Medical Schools

This article is by **Alan Blinder, Alice Callahan and Sheryl Gay Stolberg.**

Under pressure from Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., dozens of American medical schools have agreed to rework their curriculums to teach more about nutrition, according to federal officials, records and interviews with medical leaders.

Mr. Kennedy, who has made healthy eating a centerpiece of his campaign to address what he calls an epidemic of chronic disease, has spent months pressuring medical schools to adopt his ideas, threatening funding cuts and promising public recognition.

He is expected to announce on Thursday that many schools are embracing his recommendations — a development that has disturbed some academic and medical leaders who had already been alarmed by the Trump administration's quest to remake higher education.

Mr. Kennedy's effort draws on

decades of debate about how much America's doctors should know about nutrition. Many experts in the field have long argued that schools do not teach enough on the topic. But in shaping the new curriculum, the secretary has also tapped into voices and ideas from the Make America Healthy Again movement that sometimes deviate from established science.

“When I first came in I met with the medical schools and I said, ‘We want you to start teaching 40 hours of nutrition,’” Mr. Kennedy told his supporters last week at a MAHA rally in Austin, Texas, previewing the initiative before the formal announcement. “We actually developed a curriculum that's extraordinary. We said, you don't have to use that. Use whatever you want, teach whatever you want, but you need to teach nutrition.”

Doctors themselves have been arguing for decades that medical schools should include more training in nutrition. In 1962, for in-

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